Why are Christian video games deemed preachy?

Case Studies Into the Formal Elements of Christian Entertainment Software and How They Affect Player Engagement.

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February, 2026

A dissertation submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the degree of M.Sc. in Digital Games.

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First edition, Thursday 26th February, 2026

To John Doe

Some more descriptive text.

Acknowledgements

These are the acknowledgements. Hello, here is some text without a meaning. This text should show what a printed text will look like at this place. If you read this text, you will get no information. Really? Is there no information? Is there a difference between this text and some nonsense like "Huardest gefburn"? Kjift – not at all! A blind text like this gives you information about the selected font, how the letters are written and an impression of the look. This text should contain all letters of the alphabet and it should be written in of the original language. There is no need for special content, but the length of words should match the language.

Abstract

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List of Abbreviations

ECG Explicitly Christian Game 4
ACG Allegorical Christian Game 4

1

Introduction

1.1 | Motivation

1.2 | Aims and Objectives

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1.3 | Our Approach

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1.4 | Document Structure

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2

Background & Literature Overview

2.1 | What are Christian Video Games?

In an interview, games scholar Kevin Schut states that currently, there is no consensus on what defines a Christian game (Faith Forms, 2024, 8:38). This becomes apparent when one examines online discussion around the topic. For example, one of the factors that Moon Channel (2023) considers when determining if a video game is Christian is that it must overtly reference Christianity within its setting, in-game narrative, or marketing. Meanwhile, Hartgrove (2022) considers *Hypnospace Outlaw* (2019) a Christian game simply because its creator, Jay Tholen, identifies as a Christian[1]. Within the same interview, Schut also seems to imply that the definition is subject to change, given that the use of the label is undergoing constant cultural negotiation (08:50, 24:26). Therefore, before conducting my study, I needed to establish a working definition of "Christian video games".

Earlier work by Schut (2013) gives us a good starting point for such a definition. Based on a series of interviews with seventeen Christians working in the game industry, he outlined four definitions of "Christian Games". Explicitly Christian Games "feature Bible stories or passages, very clear presentation of the gospel message, and stories that very openly have a Christian worldview". As an example, Schut raises *Big Bible Town* (2010), a video game which aims to teach children about Bible stories. Meanwhile, Allegorical Christian Games "have stories that are not necessarily openly Christian but have Christian themes or messages underneath them" (p. 137). Interviewees mentioned no instances of such games, but they cited the Narnia series by C.S. Lewis as an example of this style.

[1] Although he does consider the game's content somewhat, he mainly focuses Jay Tholen's appreciation of beauty is reflected within the game. Hartgrove does not deem explicit ideological content as necessary, however.

Interviewees also raised what Schut terms as Evangelical Christian video games, which "focus on sharing the gospel with people who aren't Christians". (pp. 137–138). However, this is only a hypothetical definition since Schut could not cite an examples. Lastly, Christian-friendly games, such as Bejeweled and Words With Friends, are "clean and safe, without significant violence, adult sexuality, swearing, anti-Christian worldviews, and other things that Christians might find offensive or disturbing" (p. 137).

Schut also gives insight into which of these definitions the participants referred to when speaking about Christian Games. Most of the interviewees commonly defined "Christian Games" as either Explicitly Christian Games or Allegorically Christian games. However, only few of them considered Christian-friendly games part of the genre. Based on this observation I could have based my definition on the most common uses of the term. However, there was one issue which made me hesitant to do so — the ambiguous use of the term "Christian".

2.2 | Related Work

2.3 | Summary

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3

Materials & Methods

This section should include a recipe of what you did (explain what you have done so if someone wants to reproduce the experiment, they can). Should also include a description of statistical methods used (if any).[1]

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3.1 | Summary

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[1]For more information see: `http://rc.rcjournal.com/content/49/10/1229.short`. Last Accessed: 27th November, 2024.

4

Results & Discussion

Should include a reiteration of the experiments, and their outcome. Together with a description (discussion). Preamble should include a reminder of the aims and objectives together with a list of experiments to achieve these. Should include many charts and other visualization with appropriate descriptions.[1]

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4.1 | Summary

[1] Another footnote example.

5

Conclusions

This section should have a summary of the whole project. The original aims and objective and whether these have been met should be discussed. It should include a section with a critique and a list of limitations of your proposed solutions. Future work should be described, and this should not be marginal or silly (e.g. add machine learning models). It is always good to end on a positive note (i.e. 'Final Remarks').

5.1 | Revisiting the Aims and Objectives

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5.2 | Critique and Limitations

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5.3 | Future Work

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5.4 | Final Remarks

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A

Media Content

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B

Installation Instructions

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C

User Manual

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